

# The First Real Deadline: What the Numbers Hide

## 第一个真实期限：数字隐藏了什么

Theme: 求职、职场与职业发展 · New: 45 · Review: 18 · Planned cumulative progress: 45/6,127

### English Story

By the first minute of Monday's management meeting, the team could hear that something was wrong. Here was a **wonderful** dashboard showing a **huge** increase in **admission** requests—**especially** from a **mountainous** district—but the figures did not match the paper **receipt** kept by each local office. All sixteen charts used the same **framework**, and each looked **somewhat** convincing. Management had always called this a **big** success and asked the team to show it to investors; Maya reminded them that the missing forms belonged to real people. Maya, now practicing **journalism** at the company, asked one particular question: did the missing applications still **exist**?

Grace opened **fourteen** sample files, then **thirteen** more. A **considerable** number had disappeared after a **regulatory** update. **Seventeen** users had tried repeatedly, but the system treated every **resumption** as a new session. The problem was **increasingly** serious. A **conditional** rule was meant to **prohibit** duplicate claims; instead, it could **violate** equal-access policy by blocking people with slow connections. The apparent **avoidance** of fraud had created a **discriminatory** result.

The software vendor wanted to **simplify** the report and **authorize** release. Its representative described the loss as **petty**, then praised the **vast** benefits for an **immense** user base. Lin felt **deeply** disappointed. Good **oversight** could not **abolish** evidence merely because the evidence was inconvenient. A **preferential** success rate for well-connected users was not **beneficial** to the public, and no form of professional **admission** could excuse **concealment**.

Daniel placed a **metallic** box on the table. It held the **wreckage** of a damaged field terminal, a manual, an old **coinage** sample used in training, and a printed **receipt**. The physical evidence made the **immensity** of the digital gap visible. In areas of **scarcity**, equipment was not **plentiful**; a commuter might spend a week traveling to submit one form. The team asked the police liaison only about device theft, not about applicants. That separation mattered.

Maya wrote up the finding without **deceit** or exaggeration. The accountant calculated the **mounting** cost of correction, while Grace prepared a lawful **resumption** plan. The company would **prohibit** automatic rejection, restore the missing records, and publish the **oversight**. The decision would **disappoint** investors expecting an immediate launch, but it protected **admittance** for real users. Faced with the **immensity** of the repair, Lin still felt some **puzzlement**; yet the team's practice was now clear: strong **journalism**, careful management, and honest collaboration had to come before a promising deadline.

### 中文翻译

周一管理会议开始不到一分钟，团队就听出事情不对。仪表盘漂亮地显示某山区的申请数量大幅上升，尤其显眼；但这些数字与当地各办公室保存的纸质收据不符。十六张图表全部使用同一个框架，看起来都颇有说服力。管理层一直把这称为一次巨大成功，并要求团队向投资者展示；曼雅提醒他们，丢失的表格属于真实的人。正在公司实习做新闻工作的曼雅提出了一个具体问题：那些消失的申请是否仍然存在？

刘佳打开十四份样本文件，又查看了十三份。大量记录在一次监管更新后消失。十七名用户反复尝试，但系统把每次恢复操作都当成新会话。问题越来越严重。一条附带条件的规则原本用于禁止重复申报，却可能因拦截网络较慢的人而违反平等准入政策。表面上的防欺诈措施造成了歧视性结果。

软件供应商希望简化报告并批准发布。代表称损失微不足道，随后大谈庞大用户群能够获得的广泛好处。林伟深感失望。良好的监督不能因为证据不方便就废除证据。只让网络条件良好的用户享受优惠成功率并不符合公共利益，任何职业资格都不能成为隐瞒的借口。

丹尼尔把一个金属盒放到桌上，里面装着损坏现场终端的残骸、一本手册、培训中使用的旧币样本和一张打印收据。实物证据让数字鸿沟的巨大程度变得可见。在资源匮乏地区，设备并不充足；通勤者可能要花一周时间才能提交一份表格。团队只向警方联络员询问了设备失窃，却没有询问申请人。这种割裂非常关键。

曼雅如实写下发现，没有欺骗，也没有夸张。会计核算不断上升的修复成本，刘佳则制定合法的恢复计划。公司将禁止自动拒绝，恢复丢失记录，并公布监督失误。这个决定会让期待立即上线的投资者失望，却保护了真实用户的准入权。面对庞大的修复工作，林伟仍有些困惑，但团队的做法已经明确：有力的新闻调查、谨慎的管理和诚实合作必须优先于一个看似前景光明的期限。

## Core Vocabulary · 核心词汇

| Word / Pronunciation                            | Context meaning / source example                                                                                                                                                                            |
|-------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>especially</b><br>i'speʃəli<br>POS: adv      | adv. 尤其, 特别, 格外<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: r to a distinctly greater extent or degree than is common; r in a special manner                                                  |
| <b>exist</b><br>ig'zɪst<br>POS: vi              | vi. 存在, 生存, 发生<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: v. have an existence, be extant; v. support oneself                                                                                |
| <b>huge</b><br>hju:dʒ<br>POS: a                 | a. 极大的, 巨大的, 无限的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s. unusually great in size or amount or degree or especially extent or scope                                                     |
| <b>considerable</b><br>ken'sɪdəreɪbl<br>POS: a  | a. 相当的, 可观的, 重要的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: a. large or relatively large in number or amount or extent or degree                                                             |
| <b>wonderful</b><br>'wʌndəfʊl<br>POS: a         | a. 令人惊奇的, 奇妙的, 极好的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s. extraordinarily good or great; used especially as intensifiers                                                              |
| <b>increasingly</b><br>in'kri:sɪŋli<br>POS: adv | adv. 逐渐地, 渐增地<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: r. advancing in amount or intensity                                                                                                 |
| <b>somewhat</b><br>'sʌmhwʊt<br>POS: n           | n. 某物, 几分; adv. 多少, 几分<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: r to a small degree or extent; r to a moderately sufficient extent or degree                                               |
| <b>vast</b><br>vɑ:st<br>POS: a                  | a. 巨大的, 广大的, 非常的, 大量的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s. unusually great in size or amount or degree or especially extent or scope                                                |
| <b>deeply</b><br>'di:pli<br>POS: adv            | adv. 深刻地, 在深处, 深沉地<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: r. to a great depth; far down                                                                                                  |
| <b>framework</b><br>'freɪmwɜ:k<br>POS: n        | n. 结构, 骨架, 参照标准, 准则, 观点; [医] 构架组织<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the underlying structure; n. a structure supporting or containing something                                  |
| <b>admission</b><br>əd'mɪʃən<br>POS: n          | n. 准许进入, 入场费, 录用, 承认; [经] 加入, 入股<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the act of admitting someone to enter; n. an acknowledgment of the truth of something                         |
| <b>fourteen</b><br>'fɔ:ti:n<br>POS: num         | num. 十四, 十四个<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of thirteen and one; s. being one more than thirteen                                          |
| <b>sixteen</b><br>'sɪks'ti:n<br>POS: num        | num. 十六, 十六个<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of fifteen and one; s. being one more than fifteen                                            |
| <b>violate</b><br>'vaɪəleɪt<br>POS: vt          | vt. 违犯, 亵渎, 违反, 侵犯, 妨碍; [经] 违犯, 违反<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: v. fail to agree with; be in violation of; as of rules or patterns; v. destroy                                 |
| <b>thirteen</b><br>'θe:ti:n<br>POS: num         | num. 十三, 十三个<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of twelve and one; s. being one more than twelve                                              |
| <b>receipt</b><br>rɪ'si:t<br>POS: n             | n. 收据, 收入, 收到; vt. 开...的收据<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. an acknowledgment (usually tangible) that payment has been made; v. mark or stamp as paid                           |
| <b>abolish</b><br>ə'bolɪʃ<br>POS: vt            | vt. 废止, 革除, 消灭; [经] 废除, 取消, 裁撤<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: v. do away with                                                                                                    |
| <b>seventeen</b><br>sevn'ti:n<br>POS: num       | num. 十七, 十七个<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the cardinal number that is the sum of sixteen and one; s. being one more than sixteen                                            |
| <b>regulatory</b><br>'regjʊləteri<br>POS: a     | a. 受控制的, 统制的, 调整的; [经] 规则的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s. restricting according to rules or principles                                                                        |
| <b>prohibit</b><br>prə'hɪbɪt<br>POS: vt         | vt. 禁止, 阻止; [经] 禁止<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: v. command against                                                                                                             |
| <b>journalism</b><br>'dʒə:nəlɪzəm<br>POS: n     | n. 新闻业, 报章杂志; [法] 报刊, 新闻业, 新闻出版<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. newspapers and magazines collectively; n. the profession of reporting or photographing or editing news stor... |
| <b>immense</b><br>ɪ'mens<br>POS: a              | a. 极广大的, 无边的, 非常好的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s. unusually great in size or amount or degree or especially extent or scope                                                   |
| <b>beneficial</b><br>.benɪ'fɪʃəl<br>POS: a      | a. 有益的, 受益的; [经] 有使用权的, 可享利益的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s. promoting or enhancing well-being                                                                                |
| <b>authorize</b><br>'ɔ:θəraɪz<br>POS: vt        | vt. 授权, 批准, 委托; [经] 授权, 委任, 认可<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: v. grant authorization or clearance for                                                                            |

| Word / Pronunciation                                            | Context meaning / source example                                                                                                                                                                          |
|-----------------------------------------------------------------|-----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>oversight</b><br>'əʊvəsait<br>POS: n                         | n. 勘漏, 失察, 失败, 照料; [经] 监督权<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. an unintentional omission resulting from failure to notice something; n. a mistake resulting from inattenti...    |
| <b>petty</b><br>'peti<br>POS: a                                 | a. 琐碎的, 小规模, 小气的, 委琐的; [经] 小额的, 微小的, 小规模<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s. contemptibly narrow in outlook                                                                      |
| <b>simplify</b><br>'simplifai<br>POS: vt                        | vt. 单一化, 简单化<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: v. make simpler or easier or reduce in complexity or extent                                                                        |
| <b>conditional</b><br>kən'diʃənl<br>POS: a                      | a. 有条件的, 有前提的; [电] 有条件的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s. qualified by reservations; a. imposing or depending on or containing a condition                                     |
| <b>disappoint</b><br>'disə'point<br>POS: vt                     | vt. 使失望<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: v. fail to meet the hopes or expectations of                                                                                            |
| <b>metallic</b><br>mi'tælɪk<br>POS: a                           | a. 金属的, 含金属的, 产生金属的; [经] 金属的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a fabric made of a yarn that is partly or entirely of metal; n. a yarn made partly or entirely of metal; a. ... |
| <b>wreckage</b><br>'rekɪdʒ<br>POS: n                            | n. 残骸, 失事, 破坏; [经] (船双等的) 失事灾难<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the remaining parts of something that has been wrecked                                                        |
| <b>avoidance</b><br>ə'voidəns<br>POS: n                         | n. 避免, 避开, 逃避; [经] 回避, 废止, 宣告无效<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. deliberately avoiding; keeping away from or preventing from happening                                        |
| <b>plentiful</b><br>'plentiful<br>POS: a                        | a. 许多的, 丰富的, 丰饶的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s. existing in great number or quantity                                                                                        |
| <b>scarcity</b><br>'skɑ:siti<br>POS: n                          | n. 缺乏, 不足, 缺少; [经] 缺乏, 不足<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. a small and inadequate amount                                                                                      |
| <b>discriminatory</b><br>di'skriminətəri; (?@) -tɔ:ri<br>POS: a | a. 有辨识力的, 有差别的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s. containing or implying a slight or showing prejudice; s. manifesting partiality                                               |
| <b>preferential</b><br>'prefə'renʃəl<br>POS: a                  | a. 优先的, (关税等) 优惠的; [经] 特惠的; 特惠关税, 优先权<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s manifesting partiality                                                                                  |
| <b>resumption</b><br>ri'zʌmpʃən<br>POS: n                       | n. 取回, 恢复, 再开始; [经] 再取回, 恢复, 重新占用<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. beginning again                                                                                            |
| <b>mountainous</b><br>'maʊntɪns<br>POS: a                       | a. 多山的, 如山的, 巨大的<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: s. like a mountain in size and impressiveness; s. containing many mountains                                                    |
| <b>mounting</b><br>'maʊntɪŋ<br>POS: n                           | n. 装备, 衬托纸, 舞台效果, 上马; [化] 装配<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. framework used for support or display                                                                           |
| <b>coinage</b><br>'kɔɪnɪdʒ<br>POS: n                            | n. 造币; [经] 造币, 货币制度<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. coins collectively                                                                                                       |
| <b>deceit</b><br>di'si:t<br>POS: n                              | n. 欺骗, 谎言; [经] 诈骗, 欺骗<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n the quality of being fraudulent; n a misleading falsehood; n the act of deceiving                                       |
| <b>puzzlement</b><br>'pʌzlmənt<br>POS: n                        | n. 迷惑<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n confusion resulting from failure to understand                                                                                          |
| <b>concealment</b><br>kən'si:lmənt<br>POS: n                    | n. 隐匿, 隐蔽, 躲藏; [经] 隐瞒, 匿报<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n. the activity of keeping something secret                                                                           |
| <b>immensity</b><br>'imensiti<br>POS: n                         | n. 广大, 无边, 巨物<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n unusual largeness in size or extent or number                                                                                   |
| <b>admittance</b><br>əd'mitəns<br>POS: n                        | n. 进入, 进入权, 准许进入; [化] 导纳<br>Collocation: — (not independently sourced)<br>Example: n the right to enter; n the act of admitting someone to enter                                                          |